

then you can hit the upper limit. These days 1 gigabit/s hardware is becoming commonplace.

Broadband

This is a blanket term that applies to a host of technologies which allow for greater download speeds using different delivery technologies. It may be wired or wireless.

ISDN

Integrated Services Digital Network (ISDN) is a method which was used to transport voice and digital data at the same time. So it overcame the drawback that dial-up had. Before the advent of high def video streams, ISDN was used for voice and video conferencing.

DSL

Digital Subscriber Line (DSL) was yet another connection type which used the telephone lines but without the disconnection issues when the two services were utilised simultaneously. The process is called multiplexing, wherein multiple data streams are transmitted via the same medium using different frequencies. Higher frequencies were reserved for DLS while the lower frequencies were for the voice data. The two signals were separated using a filter which had to be placed before the line was branched for any device. Improper placement of the filter still led to disconnections when using the telephone.

The most common technology under this is the ADSL (Asymmetric Digital Subscriber Line). It is called Asymmetric because the upload and download speed were different, download was significantly higher than upload. A variant of the technology called SDSL (Symmetric Digital Subscriber Line) overcame this, however, majority of the internet users worldwide do not need great upload speeds and hence SDSL is used only in specific scenarios. Further variations like ADSL+/VDSL are all improvements over the upload and download speeds.

Cable

Cable networks made use of coaxial copper/aluminum cables similar to the ones used to connect your TV with your cable provider to connect to the internet. Cable provided a significant speed improvement and was equally widespread in use. However, this does not work like DSL, you don't have the same cable for both the TV and the internet, they had to be separate.